

Kevin Clear

Site Reliability Engineer · Production Support · Monitoring & Automation

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Site Reliability / Production Support Engineer with Google SRE and Apple production-support experience keeping business-critical, live applications reliable. Strengths in **root cause analysis and remediation**, **monitoring and observability**, **incident response and service restoration**, and **automation and orchestration**. Linux-first and finance-aware, with a hands-on self-hosted infrastructure practice spanning virtualization, CI/CD, and network security. Known for turning manual operations into versioned, repeatable systems and for clear cross-team and vendor communication.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Reliability & Incident Management: Root cause analysis (RCA), remediation planning, incident response & service restoration, MTTR reduction, on-call support, runbooks-as-code, SLA/SLO awareness

Monitoring & Observability: Splunk dashboards, large-scale data investigation, fault injection & disaster-resiliency testing, alerting and monitoring-gap analysis

Automation & Orchestration: Python, Bash, Go (Golang), JavaScript, REST APIs, CI/CD pipelines, GitOps, deployment automation, AI-assisted operational workflows

Cloud & Virtualization: Google Cloud Platform (GCP), KVM / libvirt, Docker, virtual machines, self-hosting

Operating Systems: Linux (Debian), macOS

Databases: PostgreSQL, MySQL / MariaDB, MongoDB, SQLite, SQL & data analysis

Networking & Security: VLAN segmentation, nftables firewalling, reverse proxy (Caddy), DNS, RBAC / least-privilege, passkey/WebAuthn & TOTP, security risk assessment, compliance-aware access controls

Practices: SDLC, Agile & backlog prioritization, vendor coordination, technical documentation, mentoring & knowledge sharing

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Production Support Engineer, TEKsystems / Apple, Inc.

Aug 2023 – Present

Remote — Austin, TX

- Troubleshoot and resolved technical issues across **live, business-critical applications** — closing **500+** **Jira** internal and escalated bug-report tickets since Oct 2024 and **2,000+** **Sonar** help-desk tickets since Jan 2024.
- Performed **root cause analysis** on 20+ production software defects, then validated, documented, and drove **remediation plans** that produced measurable process improvements.
- Built **Splunk dashboards** and ran large-scale data investigations to monitor product behavior, identify gaps, and accelerate triage and resolution.
- Authored 54 standardized response and runbook templates and built **AI-assisted triage workflows** (Claude, Claude Code, Gemini, and internal models), improving consistency, speed, and continual process improvement.
- Served as **technical lead** for the offshore support team — delivered training, produced management reporting and dashboards, and mentored two engineers who were promoted.
- Partnered across engineering and support teams to prioritize **backlog** work and incidents and keep stakeholders informed of workstream status.

Site Reliability Engineer, Google, LLC

Apr 2022 – Mar 2023

Remote — Austin, TX

- Contributed **600+ lines of Go** to enable disaster-resiliency and **fault-injection testing**, increasing reliability-testing coverage across Google services.
- Conducted **security risk assessments** of backend database systems and implemented automation and access controls to improve **reliability**, **scalability**, and data integrity.
- Defined technical requirements and contributed to **system design** for resilient services and monitoring solutions.

Cloud Technical Solutions Engineer, Google, LLC

Nov 2021 – May 2022

Remote — Austin, TX

- Technical **"go-to" person and SME** for Google Workspace and **Google Cloud Platform** customers — troubleshoot, reproduced, and **determined root cause** for complex issues across global, 24-hour support shifts.
- Built **playbooks, tools, and diagnosis software** that let the Server Operations team self-resolve blocking issues without escalation; partnered with Engineering on full-stack fixes and agile prioritization of the highest-impact work.

IT Generalist, Calico Life Sciences (an Alphabet company)

May 2020 – Nov 2021

South San Francisco, CA

- Provisioned, monitored, and supported **on-premises and cloud HPC clusters**, storage, and virtual machines (**Proxmox** and **GCP**) for research computing; worked with **Google Cloud security**.
- Diagnosed, isolated, and resolved complex application and system problems; implemented and documented **system architectures and operational standards (SOPs)**.

IT Resident, Google, LLC

Jul 2018 – May 2020

Sunnyvale, CA

- Onboarded **6,000+ employees** and resolved **1,000+ tickets** at 96% satisfaction across large-scale IT, networking, and device-lifecycle operations.
- Built Go optimizations for Gmail's mass-archiving feature, improving **reliability by 20%**.

INDEPENDENT INFRASTRUCTURE & PROJECTS

Plutus — Personal Finance Toolkit github.com/kevinjclear/plutus

Read-only-by-design **finance** analytics system (Python, Docker, SQLite) that automatically pulls accounts and holdings and reports net worth, cash flow, asset allocation vs. strategy, and tax-aware analysis. Built with pluggable data providers, append-only historical snapshots, and Pytest fixtures — a safety-first, tested system in the financial domain.

Self-Hosted Homelab Platform — Reliability & Infrastructure Engineering

Operate a multi-VM **KVM/libvirt** environment with VLAN segmentation, **nftables** default-deny egress, Caddy reverse proxy, and DNS. Run a self-hosted **Forgejo** git host with **CI/CD** and bot-driven pull-request automation, passkey/WebAuthn + TOTP step-up authentication on internal apps, and sandboxed, least-privilege AI-agent VMs — practicing **monitoring, automation, incident recovery, and secure-by-default operations** end to end.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

B.S. Information Technology, Florida International University — Miami, FL, 2017

Certifications: Google Workspace Administrator (Coursera Professional Certificate) · Jamf Certified Associate · Jamf Certified Tech · Kaseya Certified Technician · Apple iOS Qualification